



THE MAORI WERE THE FIRST SETTLERS IN NEW ZEALAND, MAORI

A CULTURAL REVIVAL



CULTURE

The Maori culture is a heritage passed down through the generations. The people have documented their history and expressed their feelings through art for hundreds of years. The traditional Maori greeting is a nose-to-nose touch called the *hongi*.

HANGI

The traditional, ancient Maori way of cooking is called *hangi*—cooking a meal underground using heated stones. The *hangi* is still popular with a lot of Maori people today.



1 Digging the pit

A large pit is dug into the ground and stones are laid at the bottom. The stones are heated and covered in cabbage leaves or watercress to stop the food from burning.



2 Into the steam

Mutton, pork, chicken, potatoes, and sweet potatoes are lowered into the pit in a wire basket. The food is covered with wet sheets and earth to keep in the steam.



3 Ready to eat

Surprisingly, the food takes about three hours to cook. When it appears it has a soft texture as if steamed, and an earthy, slightly smoked flavor.

Haka

The word *haka* means “Maori dance” and was traditionally performed at the onset of war to unite the people in anger and courage. It is a disciplined dance ritual where the hands, feet, legs, body, voice, and tongue all play their part, blending together to issue a challenge. There are several types of *haka*, but *Ka Mate* is the most popular.

This is the traditional Maori Haka. The New Zealand All Blacks rugby team has adopted the moves, which they perform before matches.



TA MOKO

The ancient practice of Maori tattooing is called *ta moko*. The use of full facial tattoos has recently become an art form again in Maori culture, many men now tattooing their faces as well as their bodies.

